READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27-40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

Look who was talking

Stephen Oppenheimer explores the origins of human speech

When did we start talking to each other and how long did it take us to become so good at it? One view of language development, held by linguists such as Noam Chomsky and anthropologists such as Richard Klein, is that language, specifically the spoken word, appeared suddenly among modern humans a mere 35,000 to 50,000 years ago and that the ability to speak words and use syntax was recently genetically hard-wired into our brains in a kind of language organ. This view of language is associated with the old idea that logical thought is dependent on words, a concept originating with Plato and much in vogue in the 19th century – that is, animals do not speak because they do not think. However, the abstract thought demonstrated in 20th-century experiments with chimpanzees and bonobos put this theory in doubt.

An alternative to the Chomskian theory is that language developed as a series of inventions. This was first suggested by the 18th-century philosopher Etienne Bonnot de Condillac. He argued that spoken language had developed out of gesture language (*langage d'action*) and that both were inventions arising initially from the simple association between action and object. The theory sees gesture language as arising originally among apes as sounds accompanying gestures, with these sounds gradually becoming coded into 'words' as the new skill drove its own evolution. Subsequently, coded words developed into deliberate, complex communication. Evolutionary pressures promoted the development of an anatomy geared to speech – the larynx, vocal muscles and a specific part of the brain immediately next to the part responsible for gestures.

The view that spoken language was ultimately a cultural invention like tool-making, which then drove the biological evolution of the brain and vocal apparatus, seems obvious when you think of the development of different languages. The unique features of a language such as French clearly do not result from any physiological aspect of being French but are the cultural possessions of the French-speaking community. Each language evolves from one generation to the next, constantly adapting itself to cope with the learning biases of each new set of young, immature minds.

Those anthropologists and fossil experts who accept that speech started early still tend to think of language evolution as a gradual 2-million-year process, with our own modern human species (Homo sapiens) way out at the top. A major reason for this is the perception that brain growth among humans was gradual over a similar period. Several recent changes in the fossil evidence, though, bring this into doubt.

The first of these is a re-dating of soil layers from the famous Olduvai Gorge in East Africa, where many key fossil remains have been found. A number of big-brained human species appear to be much older than previously thought, with several specimens dating from over a million years ago. When brain sizes for all available skulls are plotted against time using the revised dates, the result is startling: the bulk of increases in brain size was over by around 1.2 million years ago, with some African human species having brain volumes easily within the modern human range by that time.

So, we have the paradox that over the period when our brain was growing most rapidly, our material cultural development, as measured by stone tools, advanced only marginally; then, over a million years later, when the development of anatomically modern humans finally started to accelerate, artistically and technologically, our brains were actually getting smaller.

The additional piece of evidence that makes this paradox all the more significant is that brain size did not just leap between human species in a direct line of ascent towards ourselves. Over the period from 2.5 to 1.5 million years ago, brains were growing more rapidly than at any time since, within all the different human species. The logical conclusion is that there must have been a unique new behaviour driving brain growth, shared between all species of humans.

So, what was driving rapid brain growth right at the beginning, 2.5 million years ago? The answer may have been staring us in the face. Namely, that not only early humans but their ancestors had started the trend in the very useful skill of verbal communication. Around 2.5 million years ago, the weather took a decided turn for the worse, becoming more variable and colder and drier. The search for food became more taxing, and there would have been a real need to communicate more effectively and cope with the worsening environment in a co-operative way. The near maximum in brain size achieved by 1.2 million years ago indicates that those early ancestors could already have been talking perfectly well. Our brain, which had developed to manipulate and organise complex symbolic aspects of speech internally, could now be turned to a variety of other tasks.

So what happened in the million-year gap after that? Why did we take so long to get to the moon? Cultural evolution aided by communication and teaching is a cumulative interactive process. If each new generation invented just one new skill or idea and passed it on with the rest to their children and cousins, you could predict exactly the same curve of cultural advance as we see from the archaeological and historical record – first very slow, then faster and faster.

Questions 27–32

Look at the following statements (Questions 27–32) and the list of people below.

*Match each statement with the correct person, **A**, **B**, or **C**.*

*Write the correct letter, **A**, **B**, or **C**, in boxes 27–32 on your answer sheet.*

***NB** You may use any letter more than once.*

27 The development of human speech can be traced back to apes.

28 Animal research is essential for understanding the development of human speech.

29 Language emerged relatively late in human evolution.

30 Non-verbal language was essential in the development of verbal language.

31 The development of different languages is related more to environmental than biological factors.

32 The ability to think rationally is linked to the ability to speak.

List of People

A Chomsky
B Condillac
C neither Chomsky nor Condillac

Questions 33–37

Do the following statements agree with the claims of the writer in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 33–37 on your answer sheet, write

YES	*if the statement agrees with the claims of the writer*
NO	*if the statement contradicts the claims of the writer*
NOT GIVEN	*if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this*

33 Anthropologists now agree on the point in time when speech began.

34 The rate of human technological development in ancient times was directly related to brain size.

35 The period when the brain was growing most quickly has now been identified.

36 The development of agriculture influenced language development.

37 Cultural development has been seen to follow a particular pattern throughout human history.

Questions 38–40

Look at the following statements (Questions 38–40) and the list of dates below.

Match each statement with the correct date, ***A****,* ***B****,* ***C*** *or* ***D****.*

Write the correct letter, ***A****,* ***B****,* ***C*** *or* ***D****, in boxes 38–40 on your answer sheet.*

NB *You may use any letter more than once.*

38 Revised fossil evidence indicates most brain growth was complete.

39 The writer suggests that language development was complete.

40 An external change may have influenced language development.

List of Dates

A 2.5 million years ago
B 1.5 million years ago
C 1.2 million years ago
D 0.5 million years ago

Questions 27–32 人物观点匹配

人物：

- **A — Chomsky**
- **B — Condillac**
- **C — neither Chomsky nor Condillac**

题号	答案	题干翻译	详细定位及翻译	详细解析
27	B	人类言语的发展可以追溯到猿类。	**第2段：**“The theory sees gesture language as **arising originally among apes** as sounds accompanying gestures, with these sounds gradually becoming coded into ‘words’…” **翻译：**这一理论认为，手势语言最初产生于猿类之中：猿类在做手势时发出相伴的声音，这些声音后来逐渐被编码成“词语”。	这是对 **Condillac理论**的介绍。题干中的 **can be traced back to apes** 对应原文的 **arising originally among apes**。其逻辑链是：猿类手势＋伴随声音 → 声音逐渐被编码为词语 → 形成语言，因此答案为 **B**。
28	C	动物研究对于理解人类言语的发展是必不可少的。	**第1段相关内容：**“However, the abstract thought demonstrated in 20th-century experiments with chimpanzees and bonobos put this theory in doubt.” **翻译：**然而，20世纪针对黑猩猩和倭黑猩猩的实验所展示出的抽象思维能力，使这一理论受到了质疑。	原文确实提到了对动物进行的实验，但只说动物实验提供的证据使某一理论受到质疑，并没有说动物研究是理解人类言语发展的**必要条件**。题干中的 **essential** 表示“不可缺少的、必不可少的”，语气远强于原文。这个观点既没有归于Chomsky，也没有归于Condillac，因此选 **C**。
29	A	语言在人类进化过程中出现得相对较晚。	**第1段：**“One view of language development, held by linguists such as Noam Chomsky… is that language… **appeared suddenly among modern humans a mere 35,000 to 50,000 years ago**…” **翻译：**以诺姆·乔姆斯基等语言学家为代表的一种观点认为，语言，尤其是口语，仅在距今35,000至50,000年前才突然出现在现代人类之中。	与长达数百万年的人类进化史相比，35,000至50,000年前属于非常晚近的时间。原文的 **a mere… years ago** 中，**mere** 就有“仅仅、不过”的含义，对应题干的 **relatively late**。这是Chomsky等人的观点，故选 **A**。
30	B	非言语语言在口头语言的发展过程中至关重要。	**第2段：**“He argued that **spoken language had developed out of gesture language**…” **翻译：**他认为，口头语言是从手势语言中发展而来的。	**gesture language** 是通过动作和手势表达意义，属于题干中的 **non-verbal language**；**spoken language** 对应 **verbal language**。Condillac认为先有手势语言，之后才在此基础上产生口头语言，因此非言语交流是口头语言发展的重要基础。答案为 **B**。
31	C	不同语言的发展更多与环境因素有关，而不是与生物因素有关。	**第3段：**“The unique features of a language such as French clearly do not result from any **physiological aspect** of being French but are the **cultural possessions of the French-speaking community**.” “Each language evolves from one generation to the next, constantly adapting itself to cope with the learning biases of each new set of young, immature minds.” **翻译：**像法语这样的语言所具有的独特特征，显然并不是法国人的某种生理特征造成的，而是法语社群所拥有的文化产物。每一种语言都会代代演变，不断调整自身，以适应每一代年幼、尚未成熟的学习者的学习倾向。	原文对比的是：语言差异并非来自人的**生理或生物结构**，而来自语言社群的**文化传承和代际环境**。不过，这一段是作者对“语言是文化发明”这一观点的进一步说明，并没有明确说这是Chomsky或Condillac本人的具体陈述，因此应选 **C**。
32	A	理性思考的能力与说话能力存在联系。	**第1段：**“This view of language is associated with the old idea that **logical thought is dependent on words**…” “…animals do not speak because they do not think.” **翻译：**这种语言观与一种古老观点相联系，即逻辑思维依赖于词语……动物不会说话，是因为它们不会思考。	题干中的 **think rationally** 对应原文的 **logical thought**；**linked to the ability to speak** 对应 **logical thought is dependent on words**。虽然作者随后用动物实验对这一观点提出质疑，但题目问的是该观点属于谁。原文将其与Chomsky式语言观联系起来，因此选 **A**。

Questions 33–37 YES / NO / NOT GIVEN

判断标准：

- **YES**：题干与作者观点一致
- **NO**：题干与作者观点相反
- **NOT GIVEN**：文章未说明作者对此持什么观点

题号	答案	题干翻译	详细定位及翻译	详细解析
33	NO	人类学家现在已经就言语开始出现的时间达成了一致。	**第1段**："One view… is that language… appeared suddenly… 35,000 to 50,000 years ago…" **第4段**："Those anthropologists and fossil experts **who accept that speech started early** still tend to think of language evolution as a gradual 2-million-year process…" **翻译：**一种观点认为语言在距今35,000至50,000年前才突然出现。那些接受言语很早便已开始出现这一观点的人类学家和化石专家，则仍倾向于认为语言进化是一个持续约两百万年的渐进过程。	文章明显呈现了不同观点：一方认为语言出现得很晚，另一部分学者认为言语开始得很早。原文中的 **those… who accept** 也说明只有"一部分"人接受早期起源观点，而不是所有人都同意。因此题干所说的 **now agree** 与文章相反，答案为 **NO**。
34	NO	古代人类技术发展的速度与脑容量直接相关。	**第6段**："…over the period when our brain was growing most rapidly, our material cultural development, as measured by stone tools, **advanced only marginally**; then… when… humans finally started to accelerate, artistically and technologically, **our brains were actually getting smaller**." **翻译：**在人脑增长最快的时期，以石器衡量的物质文化发展却只有微小进步；而一百多万年之后，当现代人类的艺术和技术发展终于开始加速时，我们的大脑实际上却在变小。	题干声称技术进步速度与脑容量"直接相关"，即脑容量增长越快，技术也应进步越快。但原文恰恰描述了一个 **paradox（悖论）**：脑容量快速增长时，技术进步很慢；技术快速进步时，脑容量反而变小。因此二者并不存在题干所说的直接正向关系，答案为 **NO**。
35	YES	大脑增长速度最快的时期现在已经被确定。	**第7段**："Over the period from **2.5 to 1.5 million years ago**, brains were growing **more rapidly than at any time since**, within all the different human species." **翻译：**在距今250万至150万年前这段时期，各个不同人种的大脑增长速度都比此后任何时期更快。	原文明确给出了脑部增长最快的具体时期：**250万至150万年前**，并用 **more rapidly than at any time since** 表明这是后来任何时期都没有超过的最高增长速度。因此题干与作者观点一致，答案为 **YES**。
36	NOT GIVEN	农业的发展影响了语言的发展。	**全文无对应信息。**文章提到了气候变差、寻找食物变得困难、合作交流以及石器和文化发展，但没有提到 **agriculture / farming（农业）**。	不能因为文章提到了"寻找食物"或"文化发展"，就自行推断农业影响了语言。文章既没有说农业促进语言发展，也没有说农业没有影响语言发展，所以答案是 **NOT GIVEN**，而不是NO。
37	YES	纵观人类历史，文化发展一直呈现出某种特定模式。	**第9段**："…you could predict exactly **the same curve of cultural advance as we see from the archaeological and historical record — first very slow, then faster and faster**." **翻译：**你就可以准确预测出与考古和历史记录中所观察到的完全相同的文化发展曲线——最初非常缓慢，随后越来越快。	作者明确概括了一条从考古和历史记录中观察到的文化发展曲线：**先很慢，随后不断加速**。这正是题干所说的 **a particular pattern**。因此题干与文章一致，答案为 **YES**。

Questions 38–40 日期匹配

日期：

- **A — 2.5 million years ago：250万年前**
- **B — 1.5 million years ago：150万年前**
- **C — 1.2 million years ago：120万年前**
- **D — 0.5 million years ago：50万年前**

题号	答案	题干翻译	详细定位及翻译	详细解析
38	C	修订后的化石证据表明，大部分脑容量增长已经完成。	**第5段：**“When brain sizes for all available skulls are plotted against time using the revised dates, the result is startling: **the bulk of increases in brain size was over by around 1.2 million years ago**…” **翻译：**当使用修订后的年代，将所有现存头骨的脑容量按照时间绘制出来时，结果令人震惊：到大约120万年前，大部分脑容量增长已经结束。	**Revised fossil evidence** 对应原文的 **re-dating of soil layers / revised dates**；**most brain growth was complete** 对应 **the bulk of increases in brain size was over**。时间为 **1.2 million years ago**，所以选 **C**。
39	C	作者认为，语言的发展在某个时间点已经完成。	**第8段：**“The near maximum in brain size achieved by **1.2 million years ago** indicates that those early ancestors could already have been **talking perfectly well**.” **翻译：**到120万年前，人类脑容量已经接近最大值，这表明那些早期祖先可能已经能够非常完善地进行言语交流。	原文没有直接说“language development was complete”，但题干使用了 **The writer suggests**，说明允许依据作者推论作答。作者认为当时人类已经能够 **talk perfectly well**，也就是核心言语能力已经相当成熟或基本发展完成。对应时间为 **120万年前**，故选 **C**。
40	A	某种外部变化可能影响了语言的发展。	**第8段：**“Around **2.5 million years ago**, the weather took a decided turn for the worse, becoming more variable and colder and drier.” “The search for food became more taxing, and there would have been a real need to **communicate more effectively** and cope with the worsening environment in a co-operative way.” **翻译：**大约250万年前，天气明显恶化，变得更加多变、寒冷和干燥。寻找食物变得更加困难，人类确实需要更有效地交流，并通过合作应对不断恶化的环境。	题干中的 **external change** 指人类身体之外的环境变化，即气候恶化；**may have influenced language development** 对应天气变化增加了合作与有效交流的需要，从而可能推动言语能力发展。时间是 **250万年前**，答案为 **A**。

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